

RACHEL WESTWATER

Engineering Manager | AI Integration & Team Leadership | Agile Practices & Mentoring

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Summary

Software Engineering Manager with a B.Sc. in Applied Networking Technologies and over 10 years of progressive experience spanning network engineering, software development, and engineering leadership. Proven ability to build and nurture agile, high-performing teams that deliver customer-centric, high-quality products efficiently. Expert in optimising workflows and removing obstacles to accelerate delivery without sacrificing quality. Advocate for pragmatic integration of AI-assisted tools to boost team productivity, informed decision-making, and innovative product development.

Experience

GeckoEngage

Remote

Engineering Manager

05/2022 - Present

- Manage and develop a high-performing, product-led engineering department of 13 engineers and 2 QA engineers across 3 cross-functional squads, driving rapid delivery, continuous improvement and high-quality output.
- Mentor engineers to enhance collaboration and efficiency while embedding AI-driven practices into product development and daily workflows.
- Built and developed three high-performing, product-aligned squads with distinct tech stacks, establishing a product-led engineering mindset with clear ownership of outcomes aligned to business and user needs.
- Championed pragmatic AI adoption across the engineering function, integrating AI capabilities into product features and enabling teams to leverage AI tools to improve productivity, code quality and decision-making.
- Introduced KPIs and performance metrics covering delivery, quality and team health, enabling more effective coaching, performance reviews and targeted development plans.
- Enhanced efficiency by streamlining technical support and incident management. Strengthened collaboration between Engineering and Customer Service to improve customer experience.
- Drove organisational effectiveness through the adoption of asynchronous working and agile practices, alongside partnership with senior leadership on budget planning, vendor management and career progression frameworks.

Bluebox Aviation

Dunfermline

Software Developer

08/2018 - 05/2022

- Managed end-to-end delivery of customer solutions across the full SDLC, from requirements gathering through to deployment and support.
- Focused on scalable, maintainable code, driving improvements in engineering practices, team workflows and product quality.
- Developed and maintained features within an MVC architecture using PHP and JavaScript, tailoring functionality to diverse client requirements.
- Introduced agile practices as a certified Scrum Master (PSM I), embedding ceremonies such as sprint planning and retrospectives to drive team focus and delivery.
- Refactored a core automation tool from procedural Python to an object-oriented design using SOLID principles, enhancing maintainability and scalability.
- Championed process improvements and engineering best practices, helping the team work more collaboratively and deliver higher-quality software.

Forth Tech

Dunfermline

Network Engineer

02/2015 - 04/2018

- Provided 1st and 2nd line support for over 30 clients in a high-demand outsourced tech environment.
- Directed technical delivery, client relationships, and internal operations to ensure seamless service.
- Appointed Lead Engineer for multiple contracted clients, overseeing day-to-day operations and acting as primary technical contact.
- Streamlined service board management and ticket workflows, improving response times and team efficiency.
- Installed and configured network infrastructure (routers, switches, firewalls), supporting clients with secure, reliable connectivity.
- Maintained and monitored backup systems (Acronis, Ahsay, Backup Exec, SQLBak, Veeam), Windows SBS, and SAP/Sage environments, ensuring data integrity and business continuity.

Skills

Technical Stack:

Jira, Git, GitHub • Python • PHP • JavaScript • Laravel • AWS • Object-Oriented Design • SOLID Principles • Cisco Network Infrastructure

People Skills:

Agile Methodologies: Scrum/Kanban • Team Leadership • Mentoring • Collaboration • Cross-Functional Team Management • Problem Solving • Communication • Stakeholder Management • Decision Making • Organisational Effectiveness

Education

Abertay University
B.Sc. in Applied Networking Technology

Dundee, Scotland
08/2012 - 05/2015

CodeClan (E21)
Professional Software Development
• SCQF Level 8 Professional Software Development

Edinburgh, Scotland
04/2018 - 08/2018

Certifications

Scrum Master Certified (PSM I) — [Scrum.org](https://www.scrum.org)